

Lesson Plan

Topic: Voice and Character – Introduction to Dramatic Reading

Teacher:	Ed Rush	Date:	22 June, 2026
Class:	M3 (all M3 classes)	Duration:	46 minutes
CEFR Level:	B2	Lesson Shape:	E (Receptive Skills (Traditional))
Materials:	• Speaking test feedback slips (individual) • Breaking Bad table read – Blood Money argument scene (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MqfSr8Gu9zl) • Breaking Bad filmed scene – Blood Money (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3A-Ck_2Na6s) • The Outsiders movie – drive-in scene, 19:08 to 23:30 (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CvyYEWSK1-w&t=19m08s) • The Outsiders Chapter 2 (from ‘Dally came striding back...’ to end of chapter) • Whiteboard / screen for comparison table		
Slideshow URL:	https://elwrush.github.io/lesson-plan-writer/M3-LESSON01-DRAMA/index.html		

Lesson Aim

Main aim: By the end of the lesson, learners will be better able to identify how actors use voice to create character and to apply this awareness in a group dramatic reading of Chapter 2 of The Outsiders.

Subsidiary aim: Learners will have developed the sub-skills of watching for detail (comparing table read vs filmed performance) and reading aloud with character-appropriate intonation, pace, and emotion.

= Lesson Stages

Lesson Stages

Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
STAGE 1: Lead-in – Speaking Feedback			
8 min	To surface the problems of flat intonation, fear, and hesitation from the first speaking performances and to frame the lesson’s purpose	• Return individual feedback slips from the speaking test. Give Ss 1 min to read silently. • Elicit: “What patterns do you see in your feedback?” Board common themes – flat voice, long pauses, nervous laugh, too quiet.	T-Ss / Ss-Ss

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		• Pair share: "Tell your partner one thing you want to improve today." 1 min. • Bring class back. "These are all speaking problems – but they're also acting problems. Today we're going to watch how professional actors solve them."	
STAGE 2: Pre-watching – Setting the Frame			
2 min	To activate schema around table reads and set a focused viewing task	• Ask: "What's a table read? Has anyone seen one?" Elicit or explain – actors sit around a table, read the script aloud, no costumes, no sets, no cameras. • Set task: "We're going to watch the SAME scene twice. First, the table read – actors reading at a table, voices only. Watch their VOICES. How do they show emotion and character using ONLY their voice?"	T-Ss
STAGE 3: While-watching – Table Read + Filmed Comparison			
5 min	To observe how professional actors use voice to create emotional authenticity and compare this to the final filmed performance	• Play the Breaking Bad table read – Blood Money argument scene, Walt and Jesse (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=MqfSr8Gu9zl). 1.5-2 min. Aaron Paul's emotional read. • Then play the equivalent filmed scene from the episode (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=3A-Ck_2Na6s). 1.5-2 min. • Quick pair discussion (1 min): "What was the same? What was different?" • Whole-class feedback. Board a comparison table:	T-Ss
STAGE 4: Post-watching – Elicit the Principle			
3 min	To draw out the core principle – voice creates character, and inhabiting a role reduces self-consciousness	• Elicit: "Why does Aaron Paul's table read work, even without acting? What is he doing with his voice?" • Guide to: He's not being 'Aaron Paul' – he's being Jesse. The character frees him. • Connect back to feedback: "Your flat intonation and fear come from being YOURSELF under pressure. What if you were someone else?" • "The actors in Breaking Bad get into character. We're going to do the same thing with The Outsiders."	T-Ss
STAGE 5: Pre-reading – Meet the Characters			

Time	Goal	Procedure	Int
6 min	To familiarize students with the characters who speak in the Chapter 2 passage and their personas	• Play the Outsiders drive-in scene from 19:08 to 23:30 (https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=CvyYEWSK1-w&t=19m08s). All six characters appear. • Set the focus: "Watch each character. How do they speak? What does their voice tell you about who they are?" • After the clip, elicit voice descriptors for each character and board them: • Assign characters for the read-aloud (depending on class size, multiple Ss can share a character or rotate).	T-Ss / Ss-Ss
STAGE 6: While-reading – Group Read-Aloud			
22 min	To read Chapter 2 aloud with character-appropriate voice, applying the awareness developed in the preceding stages	• Ss open Chapter 2 at the line: "Dally came striding back with an armful of Cokes..." • Teacher narrates the non-dialogue sections (Ponyboy's narration), or assign a strong reader as Ponyboy. • Each character's dialogue is read by the assigned student(s): • Teacher calls in: "Johnny, how would HE say that? Remember – he's scared of Dally but found courage. What does that sound like?" • If time permits, rotate characters and re-read a short section so different Ss try a different voice. • End by acknowledging strong moments: "That moment when Cherry threw the Coke – we felt it because that student read it with real anger."	S (individual reading) / T-Ss
STAGE 7: Wrap-up (if time allows, otherwise spills to Lesson 2)			
0 min	To consolidate the day's learning and preview the next lesson	• Quick round: "One word – what did you learn about using your voice today?" • Preview: "Next lesson, you'll create your own scene from The Outsiders and perform it – table read first, then full performance."	T-Ss